

FIRST FLIGHT (PROSE)

CHAPTER 1: A LETTER TO GOD

Summary

The story revolves around Lencho, a poor farmer who is entirely dependent on his corn harvest for his family's survival. Lencho has immense faith in God and believes that God sees everything. When a hailstorm destroys his entire crop, Lencho decides to write a letter to God asking for 100 pesos to sow his field again and support his family until the next harvest.

The postmaster discovers the letter addressed to "God" and is deeply moved by Lencho's faith. He decides to help Lencho by collecting money from his employees and contributing his own salary. They manage to collect 70 pesos and put it in an envelope addressed to Lencho.

When Lencho receives the money, he is not happy. He counts it and finds only 70 pesos instead of the 100 pesos he had asked for. He writes another letter to God, this time complaining that God had sent the money through the post office, and that the post office employees had stolen 30 pesos. He asks God to send the remaining money directly, not through the post office, as he considers the employees to be "a bunch of crooks."

Key Points:

- **Author:** G.L. Fuentes
- **Setting:** A small village in Latin America
- **Protagonist:** Lencho
- **Theme:** Unshakable faith in God; human goodness and irony

Characters:

- **Lencho:** A hardworking farmer with strong faith in God. He is simple, honest, and naive.
- **Postmaster:** A kind-hearted man who respects Lencho's faith and helps him.
- **Post Office Employees:** They contribute money to help Lencho.

Literary Devices:

- **Irony:** Lencho's faith in God is unwavering, but he suspects the very people who helped him. He calls them "crooks" when they actually acted with great kindness.

Themes:

- **Faith in God:** Lencho's faith is absolute and unquestioning.

- **Humanity and Empathy:** The postmaster and his employees show compassion for a poor farmer.
- **Irony of Fate:** The ironic twist at the end highlights the gap between Lencho's perception and reality.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Short Answer (40-50 words):

1. What was Lencho's occupation? Why did he write a letter to God?
2. How did the postmaster react when he saw the letter addressed to God?
3. How much money did Lencho receive and why was he not happy?
4. What did Lencho write in his second letter to God?

Long Answer (100-120 words):

1. Analyse Lencho's character. Do you think his faith in God was justified?
2. What is the irony in the story "A Letter to God"? How does the author create this irony?
3. "Humanity is still alive." How is this message conveyed in the story?

CHAPTER 2: NELSON MANDELA – LONG WALK TO FREEDOM

Summary

This is an autobiographical account of Nelson Mandela's journey from being a prisoner to becoming the first black President of South Africa. The chapter is an extract from his book "Long Walk to Freedom."

Mandela reflects on the inaugural ceremony of South Africa's first democratic government, held in Pretoria on 10th May 1994. He describes the new South African flag and the national anthem being played. He acknowledges the freedom fighters who had sacrificed their lives for the nation's freedom.

The chapter then moves to Mandela's personal experiences. He describes how he had never thought of fighting for freedom as a child. He was a boy who loved to listen to stories, ride horses, and play with his friends. It was only after he grew up that he realized that his freedom was an illusion and that his people were oppressed. He understood that his freedom was intertwined with the freedom of his people.

Mandela speaks about the importance of courage, not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. He also emphasizes that a man of courage is not one who does not feel afraid but one who conquers that fear.

He discusses the concept of freedom – that both the oppressor and the oppressed are not free. An oppressor is a prisoner of hatred and is not truly free. Mandela states that the greatest wealth of a nation is its people, who are finer and truer than the purest diamonds.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Nelson Mandela
- ****Type:**** Autobiographical extract
- ****Theme:**** Freedom, courage, sacrifice, equality

****Characters:****

- ****Nelson Mandela:**** The narrator; first black President of South Africa; symbol of resistance against apartheid.

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Inaugural Ceremony:**** The historic event of 10th May 1994, marking the end of apartheid.
- ****Freedom:**** Mandela's understanding of freedom evolved from personal to collective freedom.
- ****Courage:**** The triumph over fear, not the absence of it.
- ****Oppression and Freedom:**** Both the oppressor and the oppressed are not free.
- ****The Greatest Wealth of a Nation:**** The people of the nation.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Simile:**** "The sun shall never set on so glorious a human achievement."
- ****Metaphor:**** "A rainbow nation" – symbolizing unity in diversity.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. When and where was the inauguration ceremony held?
2. What does Mandela mean by "a man of courage is not one who does not feel afraid but one who conquers that fear"?
3. Why did Mandela say that both the oppressor and the oppressed are not free?
4. What according to Mandela is the greatest wealth of a nation?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Trace the evolution of Mandela's understanding of freedom.
2. What message does Mandela give about courage and freedom in his speech?

3. Why did Mandela consider the inauguration ceremony a historic moment not just for South Africa but for the entire world?

CHAPTER 3: STORIES ABOUT FLYING

Part I: His First Flight

Summary:

The story is about a young seagull who is afraid to fly. He has a loving family – his parents, his two brothers, and a sister. All of them can fly, but he is terrified of the sea below. He feels that his wings would not support him.

His parents try to encourage him, but he refuses to fly. They threaten to starve him. He is left alone on the ledge for many days. He watches his family members flying, diving, and catching fish. He feels miserable and hungry.

His mother comes near him with a piece of fish. He is so hungry that he screams for the fish. But his mother stops near the edge of the ledge and does not come closer. She wants him to fly to get the food.

Driven by hunger, the young seagull finally takes the plunge. He dives from the ledge, and to his surprise, he starts flying. He feels his wings supporting him. He learns to fly and is welcomed by his family.

Key Points:

- **Author:** Liam O'Flaherty
- **Theme:** Fear, courage, self-belief, parental encouragement
- **Protagonist:** A young seagull

Moral:

- Fear can be overcome by taking the first step.
- Hunger and necessity are powerful motivators.
- Encouragement and love from family are important.

Part II: The Black Aeroplane

Summary:

The narrator is a pilot flying a Dakota aeroplane from Paris to London. He is carrying a letter for his wife. He is enjoying the flight but notices storm clouds ahead. He considers turning back but decides to fly through the storm to reach London on time.

He enters the storm and loses all his instruments. He is completely lost. His radio stops working, and he cannot see anything. He feels hopeless.

Suddenly, he sees a black aeroplane with no lights on it. The pilot of the black aeroplane signals him to follow. The narrator follows the black aeroplane, which leads him out of the storm. He sees the runway lights of an airport and lands safely.

After landing, he asks the control tower about the black aeroplane. They say that no other plane was flying that night. The narrator is puzzled. He wonders who helped him. He feels that the pilot of the black aeroplane was a mysterious figure, perhaps a guardian angel.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Frederick Forsyth
- ****Theme:**** Mystery, hope, divine intervention, trust
- ****Narrator:**** A pilot

****Mystery:****

- The identity of the pilot of the black aeroplane is never revealed.
- The black aeroplane had no lights and no radio.
- The narrator is saved by a mysterious figure.

****Interpretation:****

- The black aeroplane could be a symbol of divine help or an act of kindness from a stranger.
- The story raises questions about faith and trust in difficult situations.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?
2. How did the young seagull learn to fly?
3. Why did the narrator decide to fly through the storm?
4. Who was the pilot of the black aeroplane? What mystery is attached to him?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Describe the transformation of the young seagull from fear to confidence.
2. "Fear is the greatest obstacle to success." How does this story reflect this idea?
3. What is the significance of the black aeroplane in the story? What does it symbolize?

CHAPTER 4: FROM THE DIARY OF ANNE FRANK

Summary

This chapter is a diary entry by Anne Frank, a young Jewish girl who went into hiding with her family during the Nazi occupation of the Netherlands. The entry describes her feelings about writing a diary and her relationship with her family.

Anne is thirteen years old and feels that she has no true friend. She decides to write a diary and names it "Kitty." She writes about her life, her thoughts, and her feelings. She feels lonely despite having a loving family and many acquaintances.

She writes about her school life, her teachers, and her classmates. She mentions a math teacher, Mr. Keesing, who assigns her extra homework for talking in class. She is asked to write an essay on "A Chatterbox" and then later on "An Incurable Chatterbox." She writes a witty essay on the third essay, which she titles "Quack, Quack, Quack."

Anne's diary entry reveals her intelligence, her wit, and her deep desire for connection and understanding. She is a normal teenager with a rebellious streak, but she is also sensitive and introspective.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Anne Frank
- ****Type:**** Diary entry (autobiographical)
- ****Theme:**** Isolation, adolescence, self-expression, resilience
- ****Historical Context:**** World War II, Nazi persecution of Jews

****Characters:****

- ****Anne Frank:**** The narrator; a young Jewish girl.
- ****Mr. Keesing:**** Anne's math teacher.
- ****Kitty:**** The name Anne gives to her diary.

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Writing as Expression:**** Anne uses her diary as an outlet for her feelings.
- ****Adolescence:**** Anne's experiences reflect the challenges of growing up.
- ****Persecution:**** The diary gives a glimpse of the fear and isolation of Jews during the Holocaust.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. Why did Anne decide to write a diary?
2. What name did Anne give to her diary and why?
3. Why was Mr. Keesing annoyed with Anne?
4. What was the third essay that Anne wrote and what was its title?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. What does Anne's diary reveal about her personality and character?
2. How does Anne's relationship with Mr. Keesing reflect her sense of humour and intelligence?
3. Why is Anne's diary considered an important historical document?

CHAPTER 5: GLIMPSES OF INDIA

Part I: A Baker from Goa

****Summary:****

The story is a nostalgic description of the traditional baker in Goa, known as a "Pader." The narrator remembers his childhood days in Goa when the baker used to visit their house every morning.

The baker would come in the morning with his basket full of bread, which was a staple food. The children were excited to see him because they would get fresh bread. The baker would also bring special loaves called "bol" for special occasions.

The narrator describes the baker's dress – the "kabai" (the traditional dress) and the "geria" (the trousers). The baker's arrival was a part of the routine of village life. The narrator recalls the delicious smell of the bread and the joy of eating it.

The story highlights the importance of the baker in Goan life and how his presence was woven into the social fabric of the village.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Lucio Rodrigues
- ****Theme:**** Nostalgia, tradition, cultural heritage
- ****Setting:**** Goa, during the narrator's childhood
- ****Pader:**** The traditional baker in Goa.

****Cultural Significance:****

- The baker was an essential part of Goan society.
- Bread was a staple food, especially for special occasions like marriages.
- The baker's arrival was a daily routine that brought joy to the villagers.

Part II: Coorg

****Summary:****

The story describes the region of Coorg (Kodagu) in Karnataka. Coorg is a beautiful hill station known for its coffee plantations, forests, and rivers.

The author describes Coorg as a piece of heaven. The people of Coorg are known for their hospitality and their martial traditions. The Coorgis are descendants of the Greeks and the Arabs, known for their bravery.

The author mentions the monsoon season, the evergreen forests, the wildlife, and the coffee plantations. The story also describes the famous "Kaveri" river and its importance to the region.

Coorg is a popular tourist destination, attracting visitors from all over the world. The author emphasizes the importance of preserving the beauty of Coorg.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Lokesh Abrol
- ****Theme:**** Beauty of nature, cultural identity, tourism
- ****Setting:**** Coorg, Karnataka

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Natural Beauty:**** Coorg is described as a beautiful and serene place.
- ****Cultural Heritage:**** The Coorgis have a unique martial tradition.
- ****Tourism:**** Coorg is an important tourist destination.

Part III: Tea from Assam

****Summary:****

The story is about two friends, Rajvir and Pranjol, who are travelling to Assam. Pranjol is from Assam and Rajvir is visiting him.

On the train, Rajvir is fascinated by the tea gardens. He sees beautiful greenery and women plucking tea leaves. He learns that Assam is the largest tea-producing state in India.

Rajvir is a curious boy and asks many questions about tea. He learns that tea was discovered in China and that the British introduced tea plantations in India. He is amazed by the beauty of the tea gardens.

The story gives a glimpse of the life of tea plantation workers and the importance of tea in Indian culture.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Arup Kumar Datta
- ****Theme:**** Tea culture, travel, curiosity
- ****Setting:**** Assam, during a train journey

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Tea Production:**** Assam is the largest tea-producing state in India.
- ****History of Tea:**** Tea was discovered in China and introduced to India by the British.
- ****Workers' Life:**** The workers in tea gardens have a unique lifestyle.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What was the traditional dress of the Goan baker?
2. Why was the baker an important figure in Goan society?
3. Describe the natural beauty of Coorg.
4. Why is Assam famous for tea?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. What does the story "A Baker from Goa" tell us about the cultural traditions of Goa?
2. Describe the importance of Coorg as a tourist destination.
3. What is the significance of tea in Indian culture as described in "Tea from Assam"?

CHAPTER 6: MIJBIL THE OTTER

Summary

The story is written by Gavin Maxwell, who narrates his experience of adopting an otter named Mijbil. The narrator travels to Iraq and decides to bring an otter home to England.

He finds it difficult to keep Mijbil in a box on the plane because the otter is a playful and active animal. Mijbil escapes from the box and creates chaos in the aircraft. The narrator has to take Mijbil out of the box, and the otter runs around the plane, getting into trouble.

Mijbil is a curious and mischievous animal. He loves water and enjoys playing with the narrator. The narrator describes Mijbil's antics and his playful nature. The story highlights the bond between the narrator and his pet.

The narrator also describes his journey with Mijbil from Iraq to England and the challenges of taking care of an otter in a foreign country.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Gavin Maxwell
- ****Theme:**** Bond between humans and animals, adventure, responsibility
- ****Protagonist:**** Mijbil (the otter)

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Playful Nature of Animals:**** Mijbil is mischievous and full of energy.
- ****Responsibility:**** Taking care of a pet requires patience and dedication.
- ****Travel and Adventure:**** The story describes the challenges of travelling with a pet.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. Who was Mijbil and how did the narrator get him?
2. What trouble did Mijbil cause on the plane?
3. How did the narrator describe Mijbil's playful nature?
4. Why was the narrator fond of Mijbil?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Describe the bond between the narrator and Mijbil.
2. What does the story tell us about the responsibility of owning a pet?
3. How does the author use humour to describe Mijbil's antics?

CHAPTER 7: MADAM RIDES THE BUS

Summary

The story is about a young girl named Valli, who is eight years old and very curious about the world. She is fascinated by the bus that passes through her village.

Valli is a confident and intelligent girl. She wants to ride the bus to the nearby town. She carefully plans her journey, saves money, and asks her mother's permission to go to the market.

She manages to take the bus ride without anyone knowing. She enjoys the journey, looking at the beautiful scenery and the people. She learns about the cost of the ticket and the bus fare.

On her way back, she sees a cow lying on the road. She feels sad for the cow. She also sees a young woman and her child. Valli is fascinated by the child.

When she returns home, her mother is worried about her. Valli does not tell anyone about her adventure. She feels proud of her experience.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Vallikkannan
- ****Theme:**** Curiosity, adventure, childhood, independence
- ****Protagonist:**** Valli (an eight-year-old girl)

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Curiosity:**** Valli's desire to explore the world.
- ****Independence:**** Her ability to plan and execute her journey.
- ****Observation:**** Valli is a keen observer and learns many things during her journey.
- ****Innocence:**** Her reactions to the death of the cow reflect her innocence.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What was Valli's plan to ride the bus?
2. What did Valli see during her bus journey?
3. How did Valli feel when she saw the dead cow?
4. Why was Valli proud of her adventure?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Describe the character of Valli. What qualities make her unique?
2. Why is Valli's bus journey considered a significant event in her life?
3. What does the story tell us about the innocence and curiosity of childhood?

CHAPTER 8: THE SERMON AT BENARES

Summary

This chapter is based on the life of Gautama Buddha, who was born as a prince named Siddhartha. He lived a sheltered life in the palace. One day, he ventured out and saw an old man, a sick man, and a dead body. He also saw a monk. These sights made him realize that life is full of suffering.

He left his palace and his family to find the meaning of life. He wandered for many years and finally attained enlightenment under a tree in Bodh Gaya. He became the Buddha (the Enlightened One).

The chapter then describes the story of Kisa Gotami, a young woman whose child had died. She was devastated and went from house to house asking for medicine to bring her child back to life. The Buddha told her to bring a handful of mustard seeds from a house where no one had died.

Kisa Gotami could not find such a house. She realized that death is a part of life and that everyone experiences grief. She understood the Buddha's teaching that life is full of suffering and that the way to overcome suffering is to accept it and let go of attachments.

Key Points:

- **Author:** Betty Renshaw (based on the life of Gautama Buddha)
- **Theme:** Suffering, attachment, detachment, enlightenment
- **Setting:** Benares (Varanasi), Bodh Gaya

Key Ideas:

- **The Four Sights:** Siddhartha's realization about old age, sickness, and death.
- **Enlightenment:** Siddhartha's journey to becoming the Buddha.
- **Kisa Gotami's Story:** The lesson about grief and acceptance of death.
- **The Message of Buddha:** Life is full of suffering. To overcome suffering, one must let go of attachments.

Literary Devices:

- **Dialogue:** The conversation between Kisa Gotami and the Buddha.
- **Symbolism:** The mustard seeds symbolize the universal nature of death.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What sights made Siddhartha realize that life is full of suffering?
2. What was Kisa Gotami's problem and how did the Buddha help her?
3. What did Kisa Gotami learn from her experience?
4. What is the central message of the Buddha's sermon?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Explain the story of Kisa Gotami and the lesson it conveys.
2. How did Siddhartha become the Buddha? What was his realization?
3. What are the key teachings of Buddha on suffering and attachment?

CHAPTER 9: THE PROPOSAL (Play)

Summary

The play is a comedy about a marriage proposal between Lomov and Natalya, two neighbors. Lomov comes to propose to Natalya, but they get into a heated argument about a piece of land called Oxen Meadows.

Lomov claims that Oxen Meadows belongs to his family, while Natalya's father, Chubukov, claims that it belongs to them. The argument becomes so intense that Lomov has a heart attack (he is a hypochondriac).

When Lomov regains consciousness, the arguments continue. Natalya and Lomov also start arguing about their dogs. Lomov claims his dog, Guess, is better than Natalya's dog, Squeezer.

Finally, Chubukov makes them agree to get married. They are both exhausted, but they continue to argue even as they are getting engaged. The play ends with Lomov and Natalya arguing about who is better – Guess or Squeezer.

****Key Points:****

- ****Author:**** Anton Chekhov
- ****Type:**** One-act play
- ****Characters:****
 - ****Lomov:**** A nervous and argumentative man with a weak heart.
 - ****Natalya:**** A stubborn and argumentative woman.
 - ****Chubukov:**** Natalya's father.
- ****Theme:**** Comedy, love and marriage, quarrels

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Comedy of Errors:**** The characters are so consumed by their petty arguments that they forget the purpose of the meeting.
- ****Hypochondria:**** Lomov is overly concerned about his health.
- ****Superficiality:**** The characters are more concerned about material possessions and pride than about love and relationships.
- ****Irony:**** The play is a comedy that highlights the absurdity of human behaviour, especially in matters of love and marriage.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. Why did Lomov go to Chubukov's house?
2. What was the main argument between Lomov and Natalya?
3. What did they argue about their dogs?
4. How did the play end?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Why is the play titled "The Proposal"? Is it an appropriate title?
2. Discuss the character of Lomov. Why is he a comic figure?
3. How does Chekhov use humour to highlight the absurdity of human behaviour?

FIRST FLIGHT (POEMS)

POEM 1: DUST OF SNOW

Summary

The poem describes a simple but profound moment. The poet is walking in a snowy forest. A crow shakes a dust of snow from a hemlock tree onto the poet. This seemingly insignificant act changes the poet's mood.

The poet was in a bad mood earlier. The falling of snow from the hemlock tree makes him feel better. It saves his day. He realizes that even small things can bring happiness and change our perspective.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Robert Frost
- ****Theme:**** Transformation, nature's healing power, small joys
- ****Form:**** Short poem (4 lines)

****Symbolism:****

- ****Crow:**** Usually associated with darkness and ill omen, but here it becomes a source of joy.
- ****Hemlock Tree:**** A poisonous tree, symbolizing negativity.
- ****Dust of Snow:**** Symbolizes a small but powerful change.
- ****The Poet's Mood:**** Represents a shift from sadness to happiness.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Alliteration:**** "Has given my heart" (repetition of 'h' sound).
- ****Imagery:**** Visual imagery of the snow falling from the tree.
- ****Symbolism:**** The crow and the hemlock tree symbolize negative elements, but their action brings positivity.

****Message:****

- Nature has the power to heal and uplift our spirits.
- Small acts can have a big impact on our mood.
- We should appreciate the simple pleasures of life.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What happened when the crow shook the dust of snow?
2. How did the dust of snow change the poet's mood?
3. What is the significance of the crow and the hemlock tree in the poem?
4. What is the message of the poem?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Analyse the symbolism used in the poem "Dust of Snow."
2. How does nature play a healing role in the poem?
3. What is the central theme of the poem?

POEM 2: FIRE AND ICE

Summary

The poem presents two opposing forces that can destroy the world – fire and ice. Fire represents desire, passion, and hatred. Ice represents coldness, indifference, and hatred.

The poet states that he has seen both fire and ice and that both are equally destructive. He says that if the world were to end twice, fire would be the cause of one destruction and ice would be the cause of the other.

The poem suggests that human emotions like desire and hatred can lead to destruction.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Robert Frost
- ****Theme:**** Destruction, human emotions, desire, hatred
- ****Form:**** Short poem

****Symbolism:****

- ****Fire:**** Represents desire, passion, lust, greed, and hatred.
- ****Ice:**** Represents coldness, indifference, hatred, and apathy.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Metaphor:**** Fire and ice are metaphors for human emotions.
- ****Symbolism:**** Fire and ice symbolize the destructive nature of human feelings.
- ****Rhyme Scheme:**** ABA ABC B.

****Message:****

- Human emotions like desire and hatred are destructive.
- Both extreme passion and extreme coldness can lead to destruction.
- Balance is essential for survival.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What do fire and ice symbolize in the poem?
2. How does the poet say the world will end?
3. What is the poet's opinion about fire and ice?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Analyse the symbolism of fire and ice in the poem.
2. What is the poet's message about human emotions?
3. Why does the poet say that both fire and ice are equally destructive?

POEM 3: A TIGER IN THE ZOO

Summary

The poem contrasts the life of a tiger in a zoo with its life in the wild. The tiger is a majestic creature that should be roaming freely in the jungle. Instead, he is confined to a small cage in a zoo.

The poet describes the tiger's movements – walking in his cage, staring at the stars, and feeling restless. The tiger's natural instincts are suppressed. He should be hunting, roaring, and running freely. Instead, he is a prisoner.

The poet questions the zoo authorities. He wonders why the tiger is kept in a cage. He says that the tiger is not in his natural habitat and that he is suffering.

The poem highlights the cruelty of keeping wild animals in captivity.

Key Points:

- **Poet:** Leslie Norris
- **Theme:** Freedom vs. captivity, cruelty to animals, nature
- **Symbolism:** Tiger symbolizes freedom and wildness; the cage symbolizes captivity and oppression.

Key Ideas:

- **Contrast:** The tiger is a powerful animal but is confined to a small cage.
- **Suffering:** The tiger is suffering because he is not free.
- **Cruelty:** Keeping wild animals in captivity is cruel.

Literary Devices:

- **Imagery:** Visual imagery of the tiger's movements.
- **Symbolism:** Tiger and cage as symbols of freedom and captivity.
- **Rhyme Scheme:** ABAB.

Message:

- Animals should be allowed to live in their natural habitats.
- Captivity is cruel and unnatural.
- We should respect the freedom of all living beings.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. How does the poet describe the tiger in the zoo?
2. What would the tiger be doing if he were in the wild?
3. Why does the poet feel sorry for the tiger?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Compare the life of a tiger in the zoo and in the wild.
2. What message does the poem convey about cruelty to animals?
3. How does the poet highlight the contrast between freedom and captivity?

POEM 4: HOW TO TELL WILD ANIMALS

Summary

The poem is a humorous guide on how to identify wild animals. The poet describes various animals in a funny way. He gives tips on identifying lions, tigers, bears, and other wild animals by their appearance and behaviour.

The poet uses a light-hearted tone. He describes a lion by its roar, a tiger by its stripes, a bear by its hug, and a hyena by its smile. The poem is full of exaggeration and humour.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Carolyn Wells
- ****Theme:**** Humour, wildlife, observation
- ****Form:**** Humorous poem

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Identification:**** The poem gives tips on identifying wild animals.
- ****Humour:**** The descriptions are exaggerated and funny.
- ****Observation:**** The poet encourages readers to observe animals carefully.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Rhyme Scheme:**** AABB.
- ****Humor:**** The poet uses funny descriptions.
- ****Imagery:**** The poem creates vivid images of the animals.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What is the poem about?
2. How does the poet describe a lion?
3. How does the poet describe a tiger?
4. What is the tone of the poem?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. How does the poet use humour to describe wild animals?
2. Why is the poem titled "How to Tell Wild Animals"?
3. What is the central theme of the poem?

POEM 5: THE BALL POEM

Summary

The poem is about a boy who loses his ball. The boy is playing with his ball, and it falls into the water. The boy is sad and stands still, watching his ball disappear.

The poet reflects on the loss. He says that the boy is learning about the loss of something precious. The poet does not offer any consolation or replace the ball. He says that the boy must learn to cope with loss.

The ball symbolizes childhood, innocence, and material possessions. The boy's loss is a metaphor for the loss of innocence and the realization that things are not permanent.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** John Berryman
- ****Theme:**** Loss, childhood, growing up, acceptance
- ****Symbolism:**** The ball symbolizes childhood, innocence, and material possessions.

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Loss:**** The boy loses his ball and feels sad.
- ****Growing Up:**** The boy learns that loss is a part of life.
- ****Acceptance:**** The boy must accept the loss and move on.
- ****The Poet's Role:**** The poet does not console the boy because he believes the boy must learn to handle loss on his own.

****Literary Devices:****

- **Metaphor:** The ball is a metaphor for childhood and innocence.
- **Symbolism:** The ball symbolizes something precious that is lost.
- **Imagery:** Visual imagery of the ball falling into the water.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Short Answer (40-50 words):

1. Why does the boy feel sad in the poem?
2. What does the ball symbolize?
3. Why does the poet not console the boy?
4. What lesson does the boy learn from losing his ball?

Long Answer (100-120 words):

1. Analyse the symbolism of the ball in the poem.
2. What message does the poem convey about loss and growing up?
3. Why does the poet not interfere when the boy loses his ball?

POEM 6: AMANDA!

Summary

The poem is about a young girl named Amanda. She is being scolded by her parents for various things – not sitting straight, not doing her homework, and eating too many chocolates. Amanda imagines herself in various fantasy situations as a way to escape the nagging.

She imagines herself as a mermaid, living in the sea; as an orphan, roaming freely; and as Rapunzel, living in a tower. In these fantasies, she is free and independent. The poem ends with Amanda being told to think about her freedom, but she continues to dream.

Key Points:

- **Poet:** Robin Klein
- **Theme:** Childhood, freedom, imagination, parental expectations
- **Characters:** Amanda (a young girl); her parents (narrators)

Key Ideas:

- **Imagination:** Amanda escapes reality through her imagination.
- **Parental Scolding:** The parents constantly nag Amanda.
- **Freedom:** Amanda longs for freedom and independence.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Imagery:**** The poem creates vivid images of Amanda's fantasies.
- ****Refrain:**** The phrase "Amanda!" is repeated.
- ****Rhyme Scheme:**** ABAA.

****Message:****

- Children need freedom and space to grow.
- Constant scolding and nagging can be harmful.
- Imagination is a way for children to escape reality.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What do Amanda's parents tell her not to do?
2. What are Amanda's fantasies?
3. Why does Amanda imagine herself as a mermaid?
4. What does Amanda want from life?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Describe the character of Amanda. Why does she imagine herself in different situations?
2. What message does the poem convey about parental expectations?
3. How does Amanda use her imagination as an escape?

POEM 7: THE TREES

Summary

The poem describes trees that are trying to escape from a house. The trees are personified as restless beings that want to leave the house and go to the forest. They are trapped inside the house and feel suffocated.

The poet describes the trees' struggle to get out. They break through the walls and windows. The poet wants to let them go. She feels that they belong in the forest, not in a house.

The trees are a metaphor for human beings who feel trapped and restricted. They represent the desire for freedom and self-expression.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Adrienne Rich
- ****Theme:**** Freedom, nature, restriction
- ****Symbolism:**** Trees symbolize human beings; the house symbolizes restrictions and limitations.

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Personification:**** The trees are personified as beings with emotions.
- ****Freedom vs. Restriction:**** The poem contrasts the freedom of nature with the confinement of the house.
- ****Suffocation:**** The trees feel suffocated and want to escape.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Personification:**** The trees are given human qualities.
- ****Symbolism:**** Trees and house as symbols of freedom and restriction.
- ****Imagery:**** Visual imagery of trees breaking through walls.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. What do the trees want to do in the poem?
2. Why are the trees trapped inside the house?
3. What does the poet want to do with the trees?
4. What do the trees symbolize?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Analyse the symbolism of the trees in the poem.
2. What message does the poem convey about freedom and restriction?
3. Why does the poet personify the trees?

POEM 8: FOG

Summary

The poem describes a fog that comes over a city. The fog is compared to a cat. It comes silently and quietly. It sits over the city, looking over the harbour and the city. Then, it moves away just as quietly as it came.

The poem is short and simple. It creates a visual image of the fog and its movement.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Carl Sandburg
- ****Theme:**** Nature, observation, change
- ****Form:**** Haiku-like

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Personification:**** The fog is compared to a cat.
- ****Quietness:**** The fog comes and goes silently.
- ****Transience:**** The fog is temporary and moves away.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Metaphor:**** The fog is compared to a cat.
- ****Imagery:**** Visual imagery of the fog.
- ****Rhyme:**** Free verse.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. How does the poet describe the fog?
2. What is the fog compared to?
3. How does the fog move?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Analyse the metaphor in the poem.
2. What message does the poem convey about nature?
3. How does the poet create a visual image of the fog?

POEM 9: THE TALE OF CUSTARD THE DRAGON

Summary

The poem is a humorous story about a dragon named Custard. Custard is a cowardly dragon who is afraid of everything. He is made fun of by the other pets in the house – a kitten, a dog, a mouse, and a pirate.

One day, a pirate attacks the house. Everyone is scared, but Custard saves the day. He fights the pirate and defeats him. After the pirate is killed, Custard becomes brave and proud. The other pets praise him.

****Key Points:****

- ****Poet:**** Ogden Nash
- ****Theme:**** Courage, appearance vs. reality, humour
- ****Characters:****
 - ****Custard:**** A cowardly dragon
 - ****Belinda:**** A little girl
 - ****The Kitten:**** Ink
 - ****The Dog:**** Blink
 - ****The Mouse:**** Mustard
 - ****The Pirate:**** A villain

****Key Ideas:****

- ****Appearance vs. Reality:**** Custard looks fierce but is actually a coward.
- ****Courage:**** Custard shows courage when it is needed most.
- ****Humour:**** The poem is a humorous narrative.

****Literary Devices:****

- ****Rhyme:**** The poem has a regular rhyme scheme.
- ****Imagery:**** Visual imagery of the characters.
- ****Humor:**** The poem is full of funny situations and descriptions.

****Message:****

- Courage is not about how you look; it is about what you do.
- Even cowards can be heroes when needed.
- Appearances can be deceptive.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

****Short Answer (40-50 words):****

1. Why is Custard called a coward?
2. How does Custard save the day?
3. What happens to the pirate?
4. What is the moral of the poem?

****Long Answer (100-120 words):****

1. Compare Custard's appearance with his actual character.
2. How does the poem use humour?
3. What is the central theme of the poem?

POEM 10: FOR ANNE GREGORY

Summary

The poem is a dialogue between Anne Gregory and a man. Anne Gregory is a young woman who complains that people only love her because of her beautiful hair. She says that people love her for her appearance, not for who she is.

The man replies that people judge others by their appearance. He says that a young man who sees Anne Gregory's beautiful hair would naturally be attracted to her. The man says that Anne should accept that people love her for her outward beauty.

Key Points:

- **Poet:** William Butler Yeats
- **Theme:** Appearance vs. reality, love, beauty
- **Characters:** Anne Gregory (a young woman); a man (the speaker)

Key Ideas:

- **Beauty:** Anne Gregory is beautiful, and people love her for it.
- **Superficiality:** People often judge by appearance.
- **Acceptance:** The man suggests that Anne should accept how people see her.

Literary Devices:

- **Dialogue:** The poem is in the form of a dialogue.
- **Imagery:** Visual imagery of Anne Gregory's beauty.
- **Rhyme Scheme:** ABAB.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Short Answer (40-50 words):

1. What does Anne Gregory complain about?
2. What does the man tell Anne Gregory?
3. Why does the man tell Anne to accept how people see her?

Long Answer (100-120 words):

1. What is the central theme of the poem?
2. What does the poem say about love and appearance?

3. Analyse the dialogue between Anne Gregory and the man.

GRAMMAR

1. DETERMINERS

****Definition:**** Determiners are words that come before nouns to specify quantity, definiteness, or possession.

****Types of Determiners:****

****A. Articles:****

- ****Definite:**** The
- ****Indefinite:**** A, An
 - ****A:**** Used before consonant sounds.
 - ****An:**** Used before vowel sounds.

****B. Demonstratives:****

- This, That, These, Those

****C. Possessives:****

- My, Your, His, Her, Its, Our, Their

****D. Quantifiers:****

- ****Expressing Quantity:**** Much, Many, Some, Any, Few, A Few, Little, A Little
- ****Differences:****
 - ****Few:**** Very few (almost none).
 - ****A few:**** Some (not many, but some).
 - ****Little:**** Very little (almost none).
 - ****A little:**** Some (not much, but some).

****E. Distributives:****

- Each, Every, Either, Neither

****F. Interrogatives:****

- Which, What, Whose

Key Rules:

****A/An:****

- ****A:**** Used before words starting with a consonant sound. Example: a dog, a university
- ****An:**** Used before words starting with a vowel sound. Example: an apple, an hour

****The:****

- Used for specific nouns. Example: The book you gave me.
- Used with superlatives. Example: The best book.
- Used with unique things. Example: The sun, the moon.

****Some/Any:****

- ****Some:**** Used in positive statements, offers, and requests. Example: I have some money. Would you like some tea?
- ****Any:**** Used in negative statements and questions. Example: I don't have any money. Do you have any money?

****Much/Many:****

- ****Much:**** Used with uncountable nouns. Example: much water, much time
- ****Many:**** Used with countable nouns. Example: many books, many people

****Little/A Little/Few/A Few:****

- ****Little:**** Very little, almost none (negative sense). Example: He has little money (almost none).
- ****A little:**** Some, not much but enough. Example: He has a little money (some money).
- ****Few:**** Very few, almost none (negative sense). Example: He has few friends (almost no friends).
- ****A few:**** Some, not many but enough. Example: He has a few friends (some friends).

****Each/Every:****

- ****Each:**** Refers to individual items in a group. Example: Each student has a book.
- ****Every:**** Refers to all items in a group. Example: Every student has a book.

****Either/Neither:****

- ****Either:**** One of two. Example: Either book is fine.
- ****Neither:**** Not one nor the other. Example: Neither book is fine.

2. TENSES

****Definition:**** Tenses indicate the time of action. There are three main tenses: Present, Past, and Future.

A. Present Tense

1. Simple Present:

- **Form:** Verb + s/es (for third person singular)
- **Uses:**
 - Habitual actions: She sings daily.
 - Universal truths: The sun rises in the east.
 - Scheduled events: The train leaves at 5 pm.
- **Negative:** Does/Do + not + V1
- **Interrogative:** Does/Do + Subject + V1?

2. Present Continuous:

- **Form:** Am/Is/Are + V1 + ing
- **Uses:**
 - Actions happening now: She is singing now.
 - Planned future actions: I am going to Delhi tomorrow.
- **Negative:** Am/Is/Are + not + V1 + ing
- **Interrogative:** Am/Is/Are + Subject + V1 + ing?

3. Present Perfect:

- **Form:** Has/Have + V3
- **Uses:**
 - Completed actions: She has sung the song.
 - Experiences: I have visited Paris.
 - Recent actions: He has just arrived.
- **Negative:** Has/Have + not + V3
- **Interrogative:** Has/Have + Subject + V3?

4. Present Perfect Continuous:

- **Form:** Has/Have + been + V1 + ing
- **Uses:**
 - Actions that started in the past and continue: She has been singing for 2 hours.
- **Negative:** Has/Have + not + been + V1 + ing
- **Interrogative:** Has/Have + Subject + been + V1 + ing?

B. Past Tense

1. Simple Past:

- **Form:** V2
- **Uses:**
 - Completed actions in the past: She sang yesterday.

- **Negative:** Did + not + V1
- **Interrogative:** Did + Subject + V1?

2. Past Continuous:

- **Form:** Was/Were + V1 + ing
- **Uses:**
 - Actions happening at a specific time in the past: She was singing at 6 pm.
- **Negative:** Was/Were + not + V1 + ing
- **Interrogative:** Was/Were + Subject + V1 + ing?

3. Past Perfect:

- **Form:** Had + V3
- **Uses:**
 - Action completed before another past action: She had sung before I arrived.
- **Negative:** Had + not + V3
- **Interrogative:** Had + Subject + V3?

4. Past Perfect Continuous:

- **Form:** Had + been + V1 + ing
- **Uses:**
 - Actions that continued in the past: She had been singing for 2 hours before I arrived.
- **Negative:** Had + not + been + V1 + ing
- **Interrogative:** Had + Subject + been + V1 + ing?

C. Future Tense

1. Simple Future:

- **Form:** Will/Shall + V1
- **Uses:**
 - Future actions: She will sing tomorrow.
- **Negative:** Will/Shall + not + V1
- **Interrogative:** Will/Shall + Subject + V1?

2. Future Continuous:

- **Form:** Will/Shall + be + V1 + ing
- **Uses:**
 - Actions in progress at a future time: She will be singing at 6 pm.
- **Negative:** Will/Shall + not + be + V1 + ing

3. Future Perfect:

- **Form:** Will/Shall + have + V3
- **Uses:**

- Actions that will be completed before another future action: She will have sung before you arrive.

- **Negative:** Will/Shall + not + have + V3

4. Future Perfect Continuous:

- **Form:** Will/Shall + have + been + V1 + ing

- **Uses:**

- Actions that will continue in the future: She will have been singing for 2 hours by then.

- **Negative:** Will/Shall + not + have + been + V1 + ing

3. MODALS

Definition: Modals are helping verbs that express ability, possibility, necessity, obligation, permission, etc.

Common Modals and Their Usage:

Can:

- **Usage:** Ability, possibility, permission

- **Example:** I can swim.

Could:

- **Usage:** Past ability, polite request

- **Example:** Could you help me?

May:

- **Usage:** Permission, possibility

- **Example:** May I come in?

Might:

- **Usage:** Possibility (less likely)

- **Example:** It might rain.

Must:

- **Usage:** Obligation, necessity

- **Example:** You must wear a seatbelt.

Should:

- **Usage:** Advice, recommendation

- **Example:** You should exercise.

Would:

- **Usage:** Polite request, conditional
- **Example:** Would you like tea?

Will:

- **Usage:** Future actions, willingness
- **Example:** I will help you.

Shall:

- **Usage:** Future (less common), suggestion
- **Example:** Shall we dance?

Need:

- **Usage:** Necessity (negative)
- **Example:** You need not worry.

Dare:

- **Usage:** Courage (usually negative)
- **Example:** He dare not speak.

Used to:

- **Usage:** Past habits
- **Example:** I used to play cricket.

Key Rules:

- Modals do not change form (no -s, -ed, -ing).
- They are always followed by the base form of the verb (V1).
- To make negative, add "not" after the modal.
- To make interrogative, place the modal before the subject.

4. SUBJECT-VERB CONCORD

Definition: The verb must agree with the subject in number and person.

Key Rules:

A. Singular Subject + Singular Verb:

- The boy plays cricket.
- He is a good student.

B. Plural Subject + Plural Verb:

- The boys play cricket.
- They are good students.

****C. Indefinite Pronouns (Singular):****

- Everyone, Someone, Nobody, Everybody, Each, Either, Neither
- Everyone is here.
- Nobody knows the answer.

****D. Words like "And" (Plural):****

- Raju and Radha are playing.
- Bread and butter are good.

****E. Words like "Or/Nor" (Singular):****

- Neither Raju nor Radha is playing.
- Either the teacher or the student is responsible.

****F. Collective Nouns (Singular):****

- The team is playing.
- The jury has announced its verdict.

****G. Uncountable Nouns (Singular):****

- Water is essential.
- Sugar is sweet.

****H. "The number of" (Singular), "A number of" (Plural):****

- The number of students is high.
- A number of students are present.

****I. Titles (Singular):****

- "The Hobbit" is a famous book.

****J. Subjects with "And" (Plural):****

- The teacher and the student are here.

****K. Subjects with "As well as" (Singular):****

- The teacher, as well as the students, is here.

****L. Subjects with "Either/Neither... or/nor" (Singular based on the nearest noun):****

- Either Raju or his friends are coming.
- Neither the teacher nor the students are here.

5. REPORTED SPEECH

****Definition:**** Reporting what someone said without using their exact words.

A. Reporting Commands and Requests

****Structure:****

- ****Reporting Verb:**** Said + (that)
- ****Tense Change:**** Direct to Indirect (backshift)

****Key Changes:****

- ****Reporting Verb:**** Said → Told/Asked/Requested/Ordered
- ****Pronouns:**** Change as per the context.
- ****Tense:**** Usually changes (backshift).
- ****Modal:**** Can → Could; May → Might
- ****Time/Place:**** Now → Then; Today → That day; Here → There

****Rules for Commands:****

1. Use "told" or "ordered" for commands.
2. Use "asked" for requests.
3. Change the verb to infinitive (to + V1).

****Examples:****

- Direct: He said, "Sit down."
- Indirect: He told me to sit down.

- Direct: She said, "Please help me."
- Indirect: She requested me to help her.

****Negative Commands:****

- Direct: He said, "Do not run."
- Indirect: He told me not to run.

B. Reporting Statements

****Structure:****

- ****Reporting Verb:**** Said that + (clause)
- ****Tense Change:**** Direct to Indirect (backshift)

****Key Changes:****

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech

Simple Present	Simple Past
Present Continuous	Past Continuous
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Simple Past	Past Perfect
Will	Would
Can	Could
May	Might
Must	Had to
Should	Should

****Pronoun Changes:****

- I → He/She
- We → They
- You → He/She/They/We

****Time/Place Changes:****

- Now → Then
- Today → That day
- Tomorrow → The next day
- Yesterday → The previous day
- Here → There
- This → That
- These → Those

****Examples:****

- Direct: She said, "I am happy."
- Indirect: She said that she was happy.

- Direct: He said, "I will go."
- Indirect: He said that he would go.

- Direct: They said, "We have arrived."
- Indirect: They said that they had arrived.

C. Reporting Questions

****Rules for Questions:****

1. Use "asked" for questions.
2. Remove question marks and question tags.
3. Change "yes/no" questions to "if/whether."
4. Change "wh" questions to "wh-words."

****Examples:****

****Yes/No Questions:****

- Direct: He asked, "Are you coming?"
- Indirect: He asked if I was coming.

- Direct: She asked, "Did you see the movie?"
- Indirect: She asked if I had seen the movie.

****Wh-Questions:****

- Direct: He asked, "Where are you going?"
- Indirect: He asked where I was going.

- Direct: She asked, "Why did you come?"
- Indirect: She asked why I had come.

6. COMMANDS AND REQUESTS

****Definition:**** Sentences used to give orders, instructions, or make requests.

****Key Rules:****

****A. Commands (Orders/Instructions):****

- ****Structure:**** Verb + Object
- ****Example:**** Sit down.
- ****Indirect:**** Asked/told/ordered + Object + to + V1
- ****Example:**** He told me to sit down.

****B. Requests (Polite):****

- ****Structure:**** Please + Verb + Object
- ****Example:**** Please help me.
- ****Indirect:**** Requested + Object + to + V1
- ****Example:**** She requested me to help her.

****C. Negative Commands/Requests:****

- ****Structure:**** Do not + Verb
- ****Example:**** Do not run.
- ****Indirect:**** Asked/told + Object + not to + V1
- ****Example:**** He told me not to run.

7. STATEMENTS

****Definition:**** Declarative sentences used to state facts, opinions, or information.

****Key Rules:****

****A. Positive Statements:****

- ****Example:**** She is a teacher.
- ****Indirect:**** She said that she was a teacher.

****B. Negative Statements:****

- ****Example:**** He does not like coffee.
- ****Indirect:**** He said that he did not like coffee.

****C. Reporting Statements in Reported Speech:****

1. Change the reporting verb to "said that."
2. Change the tense (backshift).
3. Change pronouns.
4. Change time and place words.

8. QUESTIONS

****Definition:**** Interrogative sentences used to ask questions.

****Key Rules:****

****A. Yes/No Questions:****

- ****Direct:**** Are you coming?
- ****Indirect:**** He asked if I was coming.

****B. Wh-Questions:****

- ****Direct:**** What is your name?
- ****Indirect:**** He asked what my name was.

****C. Reporting Questions in Reported Speech:****

1. Use "asked" as the reporting verb.
2. Remove question marks.
3. Change the tense (backshift).
4. Change pronouns and time/place words.
